

AIM

AP.010 EXECUTIVE PROJECT STRATEGY

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Introduction

Purpose

The purpose of this document is twofold. The first is to assist executives in reaching agreement on the project vision, understanding the impact of the implementation on the business, and initiating the project strategy. It also assists in clarifying roles, including sponsorship, steering committee and project team. The second is to assist the newly formed steering committee in refining the general direction given by the executives for the project <Project Name> in order to achieve a successful start-up, and in turn, a successful delegation to the project team.

Overview

This document includes the following components:

Component	Description
Introduction	Shows the outline for the work sessions with the executives and the steering committee members.
Implementation Model	Highlights the model for successful application implementations; this model guides the development of the strategy for the project <Project Name>.
Project Vision and Business Objectives	Shows the alignment of the project vision with the business strategy and identifies the expected business objectives and benefits.
Project Direction	Identifies decisions made for the project based on impact and risks assessment. Includes action items to manage the impact, mitigate the risks, support key project roles and manage the project at the executive level.
Roles	Documents roles within the project environment, including sponsorship, steering committee, project team and communication.
Appendix A	Executive Insights Interview Guide

Sessions Overview

Purpose of the Executive Session

In this work session, key executives were assembled to identify the scope and impact of the project <Project Name> on the business and to make the necessary decisions so the project could start with the highest likelihood of success. As a result of the session, the project strategy was set and executives became ready for a successful delegation to the steering committee and project team.

The work session was highly interactive and focused on decision making around key questions so that the senior management team could develop a clear understanding of the best strategy for the technology project:

- How this project supports our business strategy?
- How it relates to our other business projects?

- How it fits into our overall corporate vision?
- How it fits into our IS strategy?
- Whether the goals are expressed in business benefits terms rather than technical deliverables?
- Whether these goals are realistic and achievable?
- Whether the project is likely to be supported by our people?
- How we can obtain the resources and skills to deliver the project in the agreed time-scales?
- How success can be measured?
- Who is responsible for the delivery of the benefits?
- What lessons have we learned from previous implementations?

The work session looked at ways of answering these questions and examined the wider issues which needed to be considered when introducing new technology, in order to maximize the business benefit to the organization. Attendees explored the impact of the implementation of new applications on their organization, its processes and people, identified barriers to successful implementation early in the project and created buy-in by the executive stakeholders in the organization.

Purpose of the Steering Committee Session

This steering committee session assembled the members of the steering committee to help them refine the Executive Project Strategy initiated by the executives and prepare to launch the project with the project team. As a result of the session, the steering committee built on the initial project decisions and became ready to assemble and launch the core project team.

The highly interactive work session focused on decision making around key questions so that the steering committee could engage in a successful charter for itself and the project team:

- How the charter of the steering committee and the charter of the project team complement one another seamlessly?
- How the steering committee members interact together?
- What decisions are made by whom? What are the authority levels?
- How the steering committee members play their role of sponsors for the project?

The work session looked at ways of answering these questions and examined the project issues relevant to the launch of the project team for a successful delegation.

Facilitation

The work session was facilitated by <Facilitator Name> from...

<Facilitator Name> *Biographical Notes:*

In addition, <Scribe's Name> attended the session to keep a record of all decisions made during the meeting and keep deliverables updated throughout the session.

Attendees

The following people attended the work session.

Organization	Name of Attendees	Title
<Company Long Name>		
Contract Resource		

Outline for the Executives' Session(s)

The Executives' Session followed the outline below:

Sections	Description	Time	Duration
Dinner		Friday Evening 6:00 - 7:00	
Introduction	Overview of the session: purpose, expectations, logistics, etc.	Friday Evening 7:00 - 7:30 PM	½ hour
Implementation Model Review guidelines for successful application implementation and most common causes of failure	Highlights the model for successful application implementations; this model guides the development of the strategy for the project <Project Name>.	Friday Evening 7:30 - 8:00 PM	½ hour
Project Vision and Business Objectives - Review project vision and assess alignment with Information Technology and corporate strategy - Validate business objectives and benefits, and prioritize; identify measurements	Shows the alignment of the project vision with the business strategy and identifies the expected business objectives and benefits.	Friday Evening 8:00 - 10:00 PM	2 hours
Project Direction - Conduct impact assessment on process, technology and people - Identify project risks and barriers and determine actions to mitigate risks/barriers - Develop key executive steps for successful implementation	Identifies decisions made for the project based on impact and risks assessment. Includes action items to manage the impact, mitigate the risks, support key project roles and manage the project at the executive level.	Saturday 9:00 AM - 6:00 PM	8 hours

Sections	Description	Time	Duration
Roles • Articulate sponsorship program and responsibilities • Develop Steering Committee Charter and identify Committee members • Define Project Environment and identify core project team and responsibilities	Documents roles within the project environment, including sponsorship, steering committee, project team and communications.	Sunday Morning 9:00 AM to 1:00 PM	4 hours

Outline for the Steering Committee's Session

The Steering Committee Session followed the outline below:

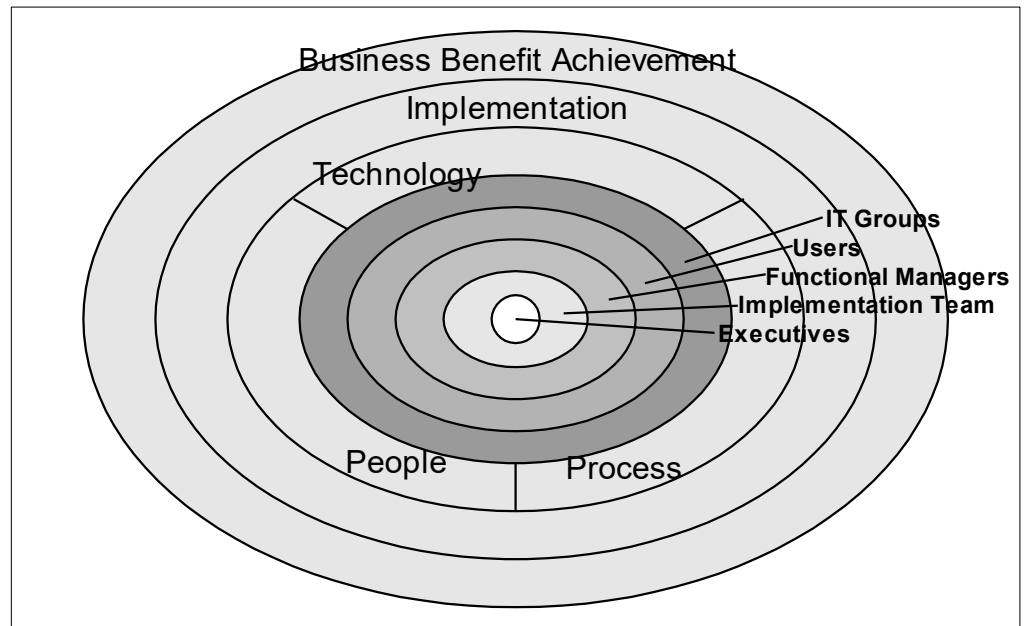
Sections	Description	Time	Duration
Introduction	Overview of the session: purpose, expectations, logistics.		½ hour
Implementation Model • Review guidelines for successful application implementation and most common causes of failure	Highlights the model for successful application implementations; this model guides the refinement of the strategy for the project <Project Name>.		½ hour
Project Vision and Business Objectives, Direction and Roles • Review vision, benefits, expected result • Review alignment with Information Technology and corporate strategy • Review risk and impact assessment • Review charter for steering committee • Introduce roles and performance measures	Provides opportunity for steering committee members to validate and refine the executive thinking behind the Executive Project Strategy. Steering committee members clarify their respective roles.		1 ½ hours
In addition to reviewing the above sections initiated by the executives, the steering committee members covered the following, in the Project Direction and Roles components:			
Steering Committee Group Operating Norms • Define the norms to guide committee's interactions	Provides the forum for steering committee members to define their group operating norms: decision making style/process, level of expected commitment, agreements on how information will be shared, conflict resolved, confidentiality maintained, ...		1 hour

Sections	Description	Time	Duration
Project Environment • Review impact and risk assessments completed by executives • Review decisions related to project environment and give feedback • Identify decisions to be made by the steering committee and determine additional input required • Make initial required decisions on project operating procedures	Further the steering committee's validation of the executives' impact/risk analysis. Members review, make and delegate decisions regarding the project environment and the project operating procedures. This guides the delegation grid and highlights the alignment of roles between the steering committee and the project team.		2 hours
Project Team Charter • Review project team charter • Clarify project team roles and performance measures • Add to the project roster	Details the responsibilities of the project team and provides the forum to select the core project team members and clarify their roles and performance measures.		1 hour
Executive Action Plan • Sponsorship actions • Communication actions • Project Team • Preparation for Launch	Captures the action items the steering committee members will execute to exercise their role of sponsor and communicator, and launch the project team.		1 ½ hours

Implementation Model

Implementation Guidelines

Successful implementations of applications include key strategies to align technology, process and people to the business strategy. In this context, they address the needs of all targeted groups of stakeholders who determine and execute the business processes with the use of the new enabling technology to achieve the expected business benefits.



Application Implementation Project Management

The following guidelines apply to the management of the implementation project:

1. Establish a clear link between project vision and business strategy.
2. Identify and eliminate or delay other projects that compete for these project resources.
3. Take the time to plan at the outset (and reduce need for damage control).
4. Clarify rules of engagement for all the parties involved in the implementation.
5. Evaluate and manage scope change in controlled manner by matching the requirements to dedicated resources: understand the impact on cost and time.
6. Revalidate the project vision periodically and keep it visible.
7. Build enduring sponsorship throughout the organization for the life of the project.
8. Obtain firm commitment from business/functional managers to provide the "best and brightest" staff consistently throughout the implementation.
9. Plan for the transition period starting with the "go live" date up to the full achievement of the expected business benefits (future state).

Technology

The following guidelines apply to the technology aspect of the implementation project:

10. Consider the long term business implications of the application technical configuration decisions.
11. Give people access to the tools and information they need to make informed, timely decisions.
12. Use customer (internal and external) impact as a criteria for decisions on technology requirements.
13. Map the infrastructure requirements for the project with the long term technology plan for the organization.
14. Plan for multiple environments to support development, testing, production and learning events.
15. Plan for sufficient lead time for acquisition and installation of hardware and networks.
16. Plan for anticipated enterprise-wide changes, such as mergers, acquisitions, , downsizing, etc.

Process

The following guidelines apply to the process aspect of the implementation project:

17. Align business processes and applications supported processes.
18. Design work flows and organizational structure to support enterprise-wide information flows; for instance, create cross-functional teams.
19. Validate business processes with the customer.
20. Document the procedures that support the business processes.
21. Define and implement post-implementation support processes.

People

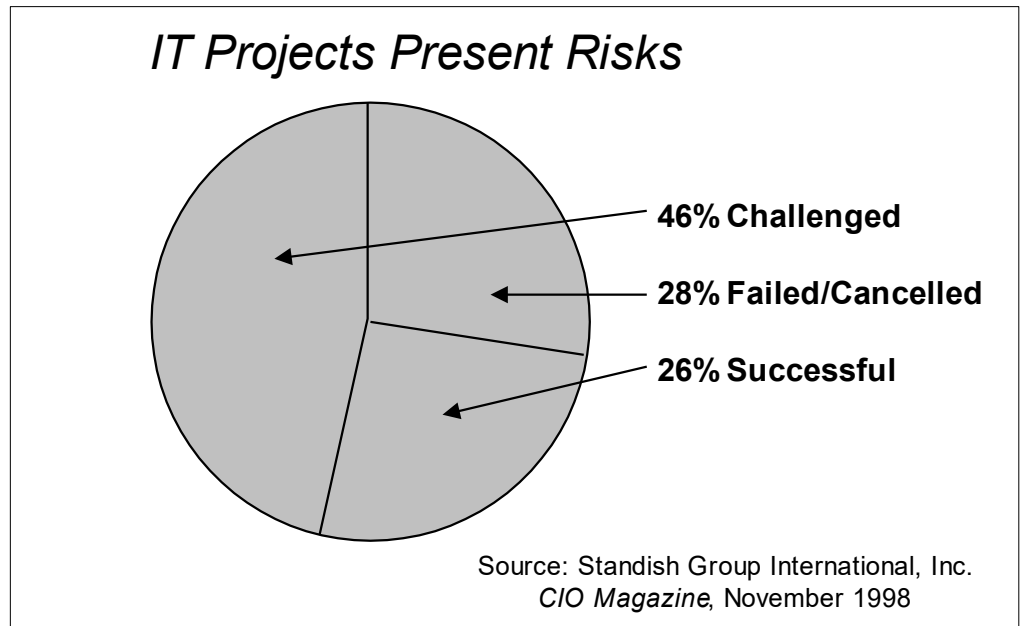
The following guidelines apply to the people aspect of the implementation project:

22. Keep representative users involved in decision making around roll out, requirements and work flows.
23. Encourage innovative thinking among users when making workflow design decisions.
24. Communicate early wins and ongoing successes to all people impacted.
25. Encourage people to share knowledge beyond their own business unit/department.
26. Re-skill users to self-sufficiency so they are not overly dependent on support group.
27. Adjust the authority levels to allow users to make expected decisions based on newly available information.
28. Provide performers with the capability and incentives to perform their new roles.

29. Provide incentives to users to keep their knowledge and skills levels state-of-the-art.
30. Implement retention strategies to keep best talent.
31. Institute recognition and reward programs for those who contribute to the success of the project.

Risks in Technology Projects

Technology projects can present high risks. The rate of failed or challenged projects is quite high.



Typical Causes of Failures

Many surveys are conducted yearly on the successes and failures of technology project.

Obstacles for Getting Benefits from Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) Implementations

Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) implementations present multiple challenges.

Information Technology and Business Alignment

Even when companies invest in innovative technology, the long-term benefits will not be realized unless Information Technology and business executives communicate better among themselves and with the rest of the organization. This is the conclusion of a five-year study conducted by IBM's Advanced Business Institute to assess Information Technology and business alignment.

Project Vision and Business Objectives

Alignment of Project Vision with Business Strategy

This section documents shared understanding of the how the goals for the project create business benefits, how they are linked to the corporate strategy, and how success will be measured. In today's business climate, the introduction of new enabling technology requires serious consideration to both the business drivers making the change necessary and the impact the change will have on the individuals and business units impacted by it. Visions must be clear, concise, compelling and aligned.

The vision for our organization, our Information Technology groups, and our project are:

Corporate Vision	Information Technology Vision	Project Vision

The business objectives and benefits we expect from the project are prioritized as shown below and will be measured as described:

Priority #	Business Objectives for Project	Benefits	Measurement

Project Direction

Impact Assessment

The following documents the impact of the project vision and of the business objectives on the current environment.

Areas of Impact	Impact: Yes or No	Level of Impact: • High: Project Critical • Medium: Might present risks but manageable • Low Little consequence	For medium and high impact: What decision(s) need to be made? By whom? When?	Comments
BUSINESS STRATEGY				
Coverage: Will this project impact more than a third of our organization: number of people, departments, sites?...				
Resource Needs: Will this implementation impact the pool of resources already dedicated to running our business?				
Customer Impact: Will the implementation cause negative impact to our business and customers (internal and/or external)?				
Knowledge Management: Will the project change the way in which we currently manage knowledge?				
PROCESS				
Business Processes: Will our business processes need to change because of the applications, including our Human Resource practices?				
Decision Making Authority: Will the project require new decision making authority levels (during implementation and post-implementation)?				
Communication: Will this project require change in our communication patterns and channels?				
Performance Metrics: Will this project require change in our current performance metrics?				
TECHNOLOGY				
Extent of Change: Will this project call for a major technological change, for example, more than just a simple tool upgrade?				
Use of Technology: Will this project require more extensive use of technology in our organization?				

Areas of Impact	Impact: Yes or No	Level of Impact: • High: Project Critical • Medium: Might present risks but manageable • Low Little consequence	For medium and high impact: What decision(s) need to be made? By whom? When?	Comments
Network and Platform Requirements: Will this project change our network and/or platform requirements (for Information Technology and user desktops)?				
Application Complexity: Will the applications require complex implementation and advanced functions?				
Application Customization: Will there be a high number of customized features and interfaces?				
Data Conversion: Will we be converting large amounts of data?				
Data Validity: Will we be working from largely inconsistent data, and/or multiple data sources?				
Help Desk: Will our current help desk capacity provide enough support to our project team during the implementation, and users during the migration and after the implementation?				
PEOPLE				
Resource Allocation: Will the project impact our resource allocation model?				
Skills: Will the people require new skills (systems literacy, business, procedural) to use and maintain the applications?				
Turnover: Will the turmoil/challenges of this project increase our people turnover?				
Leaders: Will this project put extra demands on our leaders?				
Resistance: Will this project create resistance in our organization?				
Culture: Will this project require change in our organizational culture? Attitudes, beliefs, values, work ethics, ...				
Power: Will this project change the power structure in our organization?				
Leadership Style: Will this project demand a change in our current leadership style?				
Reorganization: Will this project require that we reorganize?				
Work Structure: Does our current work structure support cross-functional work flows? Teamwork?				
Retention: Are we vulnerable to having our skilled resources leave during or after the project?				

Project Risks/Barriers

The executives surfaced the following risks/barriers to the project:

Risks/Barriers	Probability - High = 10 - Medium = 5 - Low = 1	Impact if it does occur: - High = 10 - Medium = 5 - Low = 1	Score: Probability X Impact	Priority: Ranking in Order of Scores - High = Priority 1 - Medium = Priority 2 - Low = Priority 3
BUSINESS STRATEGY				
PROCESS				
TECHNOLOGY				
PEOPLE				

Project Strategy

We developed the following strategies for the project:

-
-
-

¹ Refer to The Memory Jogger Plus, by Michael Brassard, Goal/QPC 1996, Methuen, MA ISBN 1-879364-02-6.

Roles

Sponsorship Roles

Key Sponsorship Definitions

A “sponsor” is defined as a senior manager/leader in the organization who has the power, influence and/or authority to monitor that alignment is maintained between the effort, the expectations of those designing the system and the expectations of those who will ultimately use and own the system. The sponsor:

- assumes responsibility for the project
- mobilizes the resources (of all types) to implement the project
- confirms that the project is adopted and accepted by those in the organization who will ultimately use and own the results.

The success of sponsorship is measured by the coalition it raises throughout the stakeholder constituencies. A stakeholder is someone who will be affected by the project, has a vested interest in it, can help, delay or stop the project, can affect (positively or negatively) progress and/or quality of results. Stakeholders include people internal to the organization and external, e.g., customers, vendors, shareholders, ...

For a thorough penetration and sustained momentum across the organization, a comprehensive sponsorship program includes specific sponsorship roles:

- **Executive Sponsor:** A senior executive with overall responsibility for a project, who has the authority or influence and responsibility to obtain and allocate resources, set objectives for the project, remove barriers, manage external relationships, provide policy guidance, and facilitate communications.
- **Functional/Business Sponsor:** The functional/business sponsor is usually the senior manager of an entire business operational unit and is the client of the project. End users reside in his/her organization and will ultimately be the deciding factor that determines whether anticipated results are achieved. The functional/business sponsor leads the change effort in his/her organization, copes with the impact of the change upon his/her ability to deliver, frees up resources, removes barriers, and facilitates communication.

Sponsorship Functions

In a survey of 25 highly-experienced Oracle project managers, the following functions were listed as the most important for effective sponsorship:

- Describe the business case for change
- Create a compelling vision
- Communicate publicly and privately
- Provide resources/remove barriers
- Serve as a role model

- Make decisions or see to it that they get made
- Create supporting structures such as measures, rewards, and learning
- Control scope against competing priorities
- Build coalition
- Manage risks

Measuring Sponsorship Commitment

The following questions are key to communicating expectations of sponsorship with a likely sponsor and later measuring effective sponsorship behaviors:

- Are our respective visions aligned?
- Do you benefit from this project/vision: your department? You personally?
- Do we agree on our measures of success?
- Will you put the best and brightest people on the project and keep them for the duration?
- Will you make participation in project a career enhancer?
- Will you make any necessary departmental sacrifices?
- Will you keep the executive sponsor in the loop?
- Will you be a spokesperson for the project in the absence of the executive sponsor?
- Will you defend the project/budget from competing priorities?
- Will you remain visible for the course?
- Will you warn the executive sponsor of danger signals?
- Will you take on the baton as required?

Sponsorship Pitfalls

The following are typical pitfalls our sponsors might encounter in our organization:...

- Loss of executive sponsorship
- Change in project priorities
- Reduction in funding
- Change in business objectives
- Change in company leadership
- Introduction of new technology
- Responsibility and accountability without authority

Blend of Authority and Influence

Sponsors ideally have both authority and influence in order to be successful. Authority relates to the decisions that are associated with one's title or job. A sponsor, for instance, should have the authority to commit the organization's time, personnel, and resources. A sponsor must also be able to influence opinion, to elicit

people's support and cooperation. A sponsor influences stakeholders so that they understand and accept the change brought about by the project.

Sponsor Profile Matrix

The following table profiles our sponsorship needs for the project:

Groups Impacted - Internally - Externally (vendors, suppliers, customers, ...)	How Critical? - High - Medium - Low	Expected Acceptance Level? - Pro - Neutral - Con	Name of Sponsor	Key Issues

Steering Committee Charter

Responsibility Statement for Steering Committee

The purpose of the steering committee for <Project Name> is to create an environment conducive to a successful implementation. The steering committee will provide strategic direction, allocate resources, remove barriers, protect the project from internal politics, make decisions at the appropriate level, resolve issues which have been escalated from the project team, serve as the link to the project with stakeholders external to the project, and keep the project focused on the business objectives it is intended to meet.

In the following areas, the steering committee is specifically responsible for:

- Project Management: Make decisions around major changes in scope, timing or expenditures; monitor project progress; evaluate risks; remove barriers; orchestrate celebrations of the achievement of major milestones.
- Control and Reporting: Keep executive team updated on overall progress of project; review weekly status reports from project team; identify red flags which indicate project is in trouble; review and approve project management strategies, standards and procedures.
- Work Management: Review and approve.
- Resource Management: Approve requests for resources: budget, equipment, location, tools, and people; create retention strategies.
- Quality Management: Review and approve.
- Configuration Management: Review and approve.
-

Reporting Structure

The following chart illustrates the reporting structure for the project:

Steering Committee Roster

The following people were selected to be steering committee members.

Roles - Organization - Contract Resource	Selected by	Name	Selection Criteria	Responsibilities	Date Last Updated

Steering Committee Authority Levels

The steering committee members' authority levels are defined below.

Decision Types	Organization	Contract Resource	Date Last Updated
Budget amount per phase			
Change in project scope: for example, more or less modules, changes in major functions, sites			
Project timing:, for example, changes representing a delay of no more than 10% of the project timeline			
Other decisions: for example, process to manage concurrent projects, competing resources, and show stoppers			

Steering Committee Performance/Accountability

The steering committee members' performance and accountability expectations are defined below.

Name	Performance Measures	Sources of Feedback	Checkpoints: How/How often
	Participation		
	Decision Making		
	Resolution of Issues		
	Resourcing		

Steering Committee Group Operating Norms

We agree to:

- Attend all meetings unless illness or emergency prevents; workload is not an excuse.
- Contact the steering committee chairperson if we cannot attend. Send a designated substitute in our place.
- Be prompt for all meetings; stay until the meeting is over.

- Listen attentively to others, don't interrupt, blame or launch personal attacks.
- Turn off pagers and cell phones in meetings.
- Keep meetings within the announced time frame.
- Participate; refuse to be intimidated, be assertive.
- Make decisions by consensus unless the issue doesn't impact the entire group, in which case, those who are involved will make the decision.
- Complete assignments on time.
- Use status reports to let others know progress on assignments.
- Keep those topics which are identified as "sensitive" in confidence.
- Address conflict directly and openly.
- Treat members with respect and support.
- Bring issues out in the open rather than saving the discussions outside the forum with only some of the members.

Project Environment

Responsibility Statement for Project Team

The purpose of the Project Team for <Project Name> is to ...

Its specific responsibilities are:

- Focus on the project objectives by using those objectives as the frame of reference for all decisions
- Identify needed resources: budget, people, equipment, tools
- Be wise stewards of the resources assigned to the project
- Monitor the quality of the work through appropriate standards and procedures
- Build an experienced team
- Communicate the right information at the right level of detail to the right people
- Resolve issues, or if no resolution can be reached, pass to the steering committee
- Alert the steering committee to unacceptable levels of risk
- Balance the needs and interests of the functional areas which the team represents with the scope of the project and the business objectives
- Recommend changes in organization or scope after building a business case and justifying them for the success of the project
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Decision Areas	Decision Made by	Time Frame for Decision	Additional Information Needed	Decision Communicated: by whom, to whom, when, how	Date Last Updated

Reporting Structure

The organizational chart for the project is shown below:

Project Team Roster

The following people were selected to be project team members.

Roles - Organization - Contract Resource	Selected by	Name	Selection Criteria	Responsibilities	Date Last Updated

Project Team Authority Levels

The project team members' authority levels are defined below.

Decision Types	Organization	Contract Resource	Date Last Updated
Budget amount per phase			
Change in project scope: for example, more or less modules, major functions , sites			
Project timing:, for example, changes representing a delay of no more than 10% of the project timeline			
Other decisions: for example, process to manage concurrent projects, competing resources, and show stoppers			

Project Team Performance/Accountability

The project team members' performance and accountability expectations are defined below.

Name	Performance Measures	Sources of Feedback	Checkpoints: How measured?/How often?

Project Practices

The project practices include the following areas of management:

- Project Management
- Control and Reporting
- Work Management
- Resource Management
- Quality Management
- Configuration Management

Practices in each area are defined below.

Project Management

The following reflect the practices we selected regarding project management.

- How much experience does the organization have in managing large projects?
- What is the prevailing attitude around large projects?
- How are multi-site teams handled?
- Do the usual authority levels held by project members allow them to carry out their responsibilities?
- What administrative support does the team have? What support does the team need?
- How are decisions made? Are they made by one, by all, or is this an individual's accountability?
- What are the positive and negative aspects of the current communication process?
- Is two-way communication encouraged in project settings?
- Is the organization used to working in cross-functional environments?
- Does the organization encourage innovation?
- What is the organization's perception of the vendors/contractors involved on the project?

- Does the work etiquette match the project setting? For instance, are the work hours, dress code, and other behaviors compatible with the needs of the project?
- Does the management style favor competition or collaboration? How open is the organization to partnering?

Control and Reporting

The following reflect the practices we selected regarding control and reporting.

- Are there high trust levels in place between project team members and the Steering Committee?
- What are our project management strategies, standards and procedures?
- What are our control and reporting standards, approach, and procedures? For example, how are time and expenses tracked?
- How do we manage the repository of documents/information/data developed throughout the life of the project? For instance, what is the platform, the access and the plan for organization? ...
- How do we decide if a risk is becoming unacceptable?
- What are our risk-resolution and containment procedures?
- What are our problem resolution and containment procedures?
- What is our change-control procedure?
- What are our status/progress monitoring and reporting standards, approach, and procedures?
- What is the process for approving completion of milestones/phases/deliverables?
- What software are we using for project management? ...

Work Management

The following reflect the practices we selected regarding work management.

- What are the components of our workplan? :Do we have a work breakdown structure, task dependency network, work estimate, project timeline, resource requirements profile, and work schedule? How are we updating the workplan?
- What are the components of our financial plan? Do we have a work effort distribution? Have we estimated expenses, done a profitability analysis, created a payment schedule and a cost schedule? How are we updating the financial plan?
- What are the key milestones of the project?
- What are the key task dependencies?
- What are our work management standards, strategy and procedures?

Resource Management

The following reflect the practices we selected regarding resource management.

- How important is it that the same people stay on the project team? Whom do we need to keep on the project team? How are we planning to retain the people critical to the project on the project team? How much money are we setting aside for that?
- Will we offer a bonus at the end, career opportunities, milestone's recognition, specialized learning opportunities, executive mentoring, or visibility opportunities?
- Does the usual work ethic match the workload expectations?
- How does serving on the project team fit with the member's current development plan and career? What will the career path be for those people serving on the project team? What/where will they go back to after the project?
- What is the compensation plan for the project team members?
- What skills (technical, functional, business) do the project team members need?
- How are we going to administer required learning events? How will we track the required learning?
- How are we communicating performance management expectations?
- How are we going to manage performance? Who will reinforce and improve performance as needed?
- What performance-management tools do we need?
- How are we going to orient new team members?
- How are we going to transition team members out when we need to?
- How are we going to terminate a non-performing team member?
- Where is the team located?
- What equipment does the team need? How is the equipment acquired and released? What components do we include in our physical resource plan? How do we update our physical resource plan?
- How will we extend the required support/help functions to the implementation team?

Quality Management

The following reflect the practices we selected regarding quality management.

- What are our quality management standards, strategy, and procedures? How are we assessing/measuring quality?

Configuration Management

The following reflect the practices we selected regarding configuration management.

- What are our configuration management standards, strategy, and procedures?
How will we handle document control, configuration control, release management, and configuration status accounting?

Project Team Charter

In addition to the responsibility statement captured above for the project team, the following captures the charter of the project team for <Project Name>.

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-

Communication Roles

The following describes the responsibilities assigned to the executives to initiate the communications for the project.

Executive Decisions	Source of Communication (Spokesperson)	Audience: - Steering Committee (by name) - Project Team (by name) - General Audiences	How will the message be communicated? When?	Date Last Updated
Start up communications - Eliciting participation and acceptance of steering committee members - Eliciting participation and acceptance of sponsors - Eliciting participation and acceptance of project team members				
Project Management - Authorization decision making levels - Performance criteria for the steering committee - Performance criteria for the project team - Steering Committee Charter - Project Roles - Project Environment -				
Resource Management - List of resource required				
Risk Management -				
Quality Management -				
Issue Management -				
Change Control -				
Status Monitoring and Reporting -				



Executive Action Plan

Action Items

The steering committee members agreed to the following action items to initiate the project:

Actions	Who (Leaders/helpers)	Timeline

Open and Closed Issues for this Deliverable

Open Issues

ID	Issue	Resolution	Responsibility	Target Date	Impact Date

Closed Issues

ID	Issue	Resolution	Responsibility	Target Date	Impact Date

Appendix - Interview Guide

Executive Insights Interview Questions

Executives were asked the following questions:

Vendor Sales Representative Interview Guide

1. Has <Company Long Name> worked with the vendor before? If so, what is their experience with the vendor?
2. What is <Company Long Name> trying to accomplish with the implementation of these applications?
3. Is it mission-critical, a business change, a process change or only a technology change?
4. What is the extent of the departments/sites impacted? Is it enterprise-wide or limited to a specific business unit(s)?
5. How many sites are there in the organization? (Local and in other countries?)
6. What applications are they considering?
7. What number of licenses?
8. Are there any other parties involved (Integrators, Large consulting firms, other product suppliers)? What is the nature of <Company Long Name> relationship with these parties?
9. What is the size of the enterprise and the supporting Information Technology infrastructure?
10. Does the organization have a clear understanding of how this project supports their business objectives? Is there a business case documenting the benefits for the technological change?
11. What implementation approach are they considering, for example, incremental, big bang, parallel period, etc.?
12. What time frame are they considering and how aggressive is it?
13. What is the availability of skilled resources in the organization? Technical and non-technical? How committed is the organization to free up the skilled resources for the project?
14. Who are the key players? Do they correspond to the power sources in the organization? What is your relationship with these key players?
15. How strong is the sponsorship behind this project? At what level?
16. Who is the visible sponsor? What is your relationship with this sponsor?
17. Who are the people likely to oppose the project?
18. Is it a unionized environment?
19. What are the key characteristics of <Company Long Name>'s organizational culture?
20. What inhibitors do you foresee? Technical, organizational, etc.

21. How do you rate the ability of the enterprise to absorb the business and cultural change that will result from this implementation?
22. What are the financial restrictions?
23. Are they using a standard implementation methodology?
24. Is the <Company Long Name> considering outsourcing for any of the key implementation roles, for example, installation, learning events, support, etc.?

Executive Stakeholder Interview Guide

Executive Stakeholders include the Chief Executive Officer (CEO), Chief Operations Officer (COO), Chief Financial Officer (CFO), Chief Information Officer (CIO) and other high-level executives from impacted business units.

1. What do you want to accomplish with the implementation of these applications? What is the business case? What benefits/performance improvement do you want to achieve in your organization/department? What are you willing to do to make this happen?
2. How does this project support your organization's business strategy? Your department's?
3. What are the specific business benefits you want to realize for your organization/department?
4. How does this implementation project relate to your other business projects?
5. Do you want to use the current technological change to initiate other changes in other areas such as customer service, management culture, work structure, etc.?
6. How aggressive are the goals?
7. What do you see as leverage points for this project?
8. What do you see as major obstacles to this project?
9. Is it likely to be supported by the management team? By the users?
10. Will your customers feel a direct impact from the project?
11. Do you have the resources and skills necessary to implement successfully?
12. How will success be measured?
13. Who is responsible for delivering results?
14. What has your organization's experience been with major change?
15. How do you rate the ability of the enterprise to absorb the business and cultural change that will result from this implementation?
16. What role do you and your team play in this implementation? What are your performance expectations for the steering committee and for the project team? Who are the key players to involve in the communication process during the project?
17. What type of support are you expecting from the vendor?
18. What is the history of sponsorship of Information Technology projects?
19. How technology literate is your organization?

20. What are concurrent projects that might compete for resources, for example, acquisitions, divestiture?
21. How do you communicate with your team, from your direct reports all the way to the front line? What is the most effective way for the organization to give/get real information (high-touch and/or high-tech)?